VOL 125 #2 MARCH - APRIL 2020

THE OFFICIAL PUBLICATION OF THE SAN ANTONIO PHILATELIC ASSOCIATION FOUNDED 1896

The PHILATEX

A.P.S. Ch. # 53-0388 sastamps.org T.P.A. Life Ch. # 3

MEETING CALENDAR 2020

MARCH			APRIL		
6	Juniors Program: "Show & Tell"	6:15 pm 7:30 pm	3	Juniors Program: "Show & Tell"	6:15 pm 7:30 pm
13	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:30 pm	10	NO MEETING HAPPY EASTER	
20	Program -- "1938" by Howard Wallace	7:30 pm	17	Auction -- Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:15)	7:30 pm
27	Auction -- Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:15)	7:30 pm	24	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:30 pm
8	Daylight Savings starts. Move clock forward from 2:00am to 3:00am.		22	EARTH DAY	

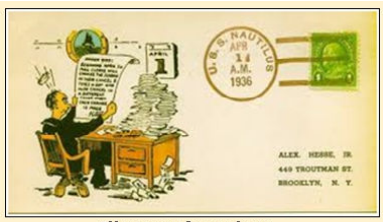
MAY 01-Show & Tell 8-Bourse 15-Program 22-Auction 29- No Meeting - Memorial Day

EDITOR'S CORNER

Notice that the March Auction has switched days with the Bourse. This was done because of scheduling problems for our Treasurer, and one of our Auctioneers.

St. Patrick's Day is March 17. The history of St. Patrick's Day dates back to the early 17th century when it was made an official Christian feast day, and brought to the US by Irish immigrants. The firstpublic celebration took place in Boston, Massachusetts in 1737. In 1780 General George Washington commanded soldiers of Irish descent in the Continental Army and allowed his troops a holiday on March 17. This event became known as The St. Patrick's Day Encampment of 1780, and is now widely recognised and observed throughout the country. (stamp is Ireland Scott #96)

April Fool's Day: The history of April Fool's Day 2020 is not clear. There is no first "April Fool's Day" that can be pinpointed on the calendar. The closest point in time that can be identified as the beginning of this tradition was in 1582, in France.Prior to that year, the New Year was celebrated for 8 days, beginning on March 25, and culminating on April 1. Then the Gregorian calendar was introduced under Charles IX, and the New Year's Day was mooved to January 1. There were some people, however, who hadn't heard or didn't believe the change in the date, so they continued to celebrate New Year's Day on April 1. Others played tricks on them and called them "April fools." They sent them on a "fool's errand" or tried to make them believe that something false was true. This custom continued to be observed in Western Europe and spread to the United States and the rest of the world.



Illustrated envelope
USA postmarked 1 Apr 1936

LEA SENGHAAS & DORA ROBERTS

PHILATEX: Editors Lea Senghaas & Dora Roberts
Labels Fred Groth
Mailing Jack Virta

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P.O. Box 33113
San Antonio, TX 78265

SAPA meets at MacArthur Park Lutheran Church, 2903 Nacogdoches Rd, every Friday night at 7:30 pm in Bldg. #1, facing Nacogdoches Rd. Yearly dues are $20.00, prorated.

ELECTED OFFICERS:

President:	Dr. Eric Shepherd
Vice President:	Chip Swinney
Secretary:	Pat Richmond
Treasurer:	Fred Groth
Membership Chair:	Dora Roberts
Communications Chair:	George Garten
Historian:	Fred Groth
Auctioneer:	Chip Swinney
Assistant Auctioneers:	Steve Mabie
Librarian:	Debbie Osuna
Assistant Librarian:	Jim Kitchen

BOARD OF GOVERNORS:

Board President:	Dr. Eric Shepherd
All Elected Officers:	(see above)
Past President:	Jack Virta
One year term:	Nancy Mabie
Two year term:	Lea Senghaas
Parliamentarian:	Harry Greer
Honorary Board Member	Kathy Beer

APPOINTED:

Auditing Committee:	Tony Bir (Chairman)

LIAISON CONTACT PERSONS:

American Philatelic Society:	Fred Groth
Austin-Texas Stamp Club:	Lyle Boardman
Texas Philatelic Association:	Dr. Eric Shepherd
APS Circuit Books	Dr. Eric Shepherd

WE WELCOME VISITORS

SAPA is always happy to welcome visitors. We hope you will enjoy our activities and wish to join us as members.

All visitors are welcome to purchase stamps at our auctions, bourses and bag nights. Anyone wishing to sell or trade at our meetings must be a member.

AUCTION ETIQUETTE :

Be sure to get your Bidder's number card before the auction starts. Come early and look over the lots for sale before the auction. During the auction, lots will be identified by their lot number and a brief description of the lot.

When bidding for a lot, please raise your Bidder's Number card and keep it up until you no longer wish to bid. Flipping the card up and down is confusing for the auctioneers.

Please keep extraneous conversation to a minimum. This makes it easier for everyone to hear what the auctioneer is selling, and allows the auctioneer to more easily keep track of the bidding.

While your purchases will be given to you during the auction, please wait until the end of the auction to pay for them. Your name will be called as the tallys are completed. Those who are only buying will be called first. Buyers who are also sellers will be called next. Checks made out to S.A.P.A. are acceptable. Sellers with unsold lots should be sure to pick up their lots before leaving.

Please be sure to return the Bidder's Number cards so that we can use them again in the following auctions.

We look forward to meeting you.

President's Message

My yard is showing the first signs of spring. The grass is growing, the ash tree is starting to bud and my native rose bush is in bloom. I think all the freezes are done for the year, so I am going to take a chance and move the fruit trees out of the greenhouse. The spring rains are starting to come with some frequency. These have been a good times to work on some of my collections. I spent last week updating all of my stamp want lists before the spring stamp shows. This week I am working on updating my postcard lists prior to the postcard show next month in Dallas. This is good time to sort out all those duplicates or stamps you don't want and bring them to our monthly auctions. Also remember to go and see our local stamp dealers and give them your support.

Dr. Eric Shepherd

Mar.2020 phone **210-906-2655**

PROGRAMS NOTES

Mar 20 - "National Airmail Week of 1938" by Howard Wallace Howard tells me that his program is about the 20th Anniversary of airmail of the U.S. That week was May 15-21st of 1938. Howard came to me about two years ago with this idea for a program. It sounds very interesting. I know we have many airmail enthusiasts in the club and my guess is that this program will be rewarding and informative. Well, Howard, amaze us!!!! Show us what you got!!! He also has lots of covers to show!!! I personally am looking forward to his program since I was born in 1936. (Oops! I'm not suppose to tell my age.) O.K., Howard, the ball is in your court.

Yours in Philately, Pat Richmond

Pat Richmond reminds all members that tickets for the Annual Picnic on June 19th will be available starting in March. The entree will be the delicious beef briskit from BBQ Station. The sides, salads, and desserts will be brought as pot-luck. Be sure to get your tickets early so we know how much meat to get.

UPCOMING SHOWS & BOURSES

March 13-14 DALLAS TSDA, Richardson Civic Center, 411 W. Arapaho Rd, Richardson, TX 75080-4551 (Friday 10-5, Saturday 9-4)

March 20-21 HOUSTON TSDA, Crowne Plaza Hotel, 7611 Katy Freeway (IH-10 West), Houston, TX 77024. (Friday 10-5, Saturday 9-4)

San Antonio & South Texas Postcard Club Corner Mar/Apr

The San Antonio & South Texas Postcard Club meetings are held on the third Monday of each month. Our next two meetings will be held on March 16 and April 20. We continue to meet at the La Madeleine French Bakery & Restaurant, 4820 Broadway in Alamo Heights. Meetings start at 7:00 pm, but members are encouraged to come at 6:00 to grab a meal, socialize, and share, sell, buy, or trade postcards. Each meeting includes a short presentation by a member on some segment of his or her postcard collection. The postcard club is open to anyone who collects or is simply interested in postcards. The annual membership dues are $10.00. For more information about the San Antonio & South Texas Postcard Club, contact club secretary, Nancy Mabie at NRMabie@gmail.com.

NEW LISTING OF MEMBER'S COLLECTING INTERESTS

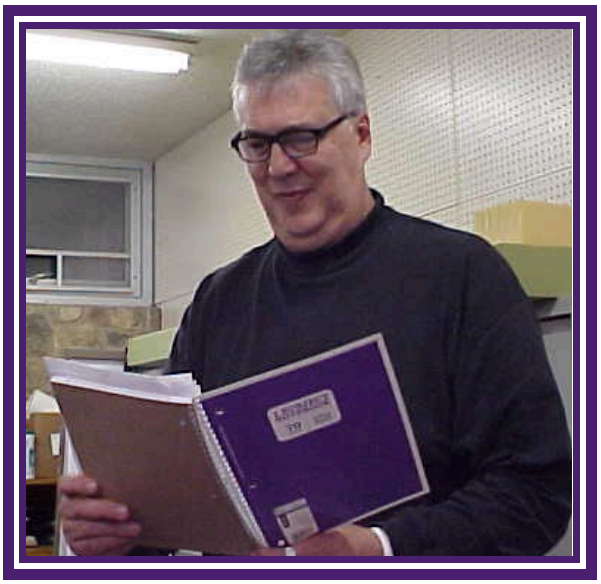
As a new member, I can attest to the desire to know other members' collecting interests as an early step in familiarization and sharing of common interests. At a recent meeting, I suggested that the club compile information on members' collecting interests to share strictly amongst ourselves. There was a consensus that this would be a worthy undertaking.

I was asked to contact all members to amass the information on everyone's interests for publication in the near future. A succinct statement will suffice; for example, my interests are stamps of Great Britain, British North America and the US. I will collect the responses and forward them to the Board for publication in a manner to be determined.

Please forward your information, and any comments and concerns, to me at bouv1946@gmail.com. I will honor requests for confidentiality but be aware this compilation is useful only if shared among the membership.

Bob Bouvier Member No. 2859

Addendum: I want to correct one detail in the SAPA report of my presentation on Stockhomia 2019. The king of Sweden attended (indeed, he opened the event) but Queen Elizabeth did not attend. Her Majesty was a patron of the event since she is the patron of the Royal Philatelic Society of London whose 150th anniversary was the motivation for the event. In this connection, several items from the Royal Collection were on display.



"Philatelic Quiz II"
by Tony Bir January 24, 2020

Well, Tony did it again. He came into the Choir Room with a blast. His quiz this year, was even more maddening that last year's. He had 7 (count them) pages of questions for us to answer. Would he just give us the page---NOOOOOOO. He had to read each question individually then we had to answer them. He's tricky!!! One of my professors got complaints about how tricky his questions were, but he just said that he was interested in 'refinement of data'. Well, I can tell you, Tony was after refinement of data!!! One had to listen to the questions very carefully!!!

Anyway, he read the questions individually and we circled our choice of answers on our papers.

Here is an example of our choice of answers for question # 1:

1-Breast cancer research
2-Wildlife Management
3-the APS
4-Children's Hospitals
5-Fred Groth's Drinking and Party Fund

Then there are the choices for Question # 25

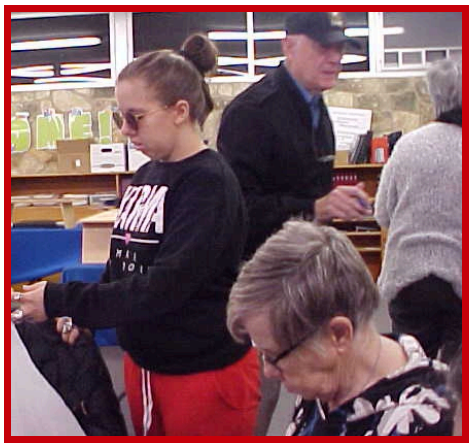
1-Issued 37 Billion at a cost of $70 million and destroyed $2.8 Billion of stamps
2-Issued 2.6 billion stamps and sold 2.3 billion.
3-Filed for Chapter 13 Protection
4-Issued 7.6 billion stamps costing $26 million and destroyed all previous commemoratives and definitives, leaving only the forever stamps in stock.
5-Sold over $200,000 worth of stamps to Fred Groth.

Poor Fred!!! I'm glad he's a good sport. Or was it that Tony took advantage of Fred's absence to target him??? Oh well, only Tony knows. . .

If you had all the correct answers, these letters/numbers/symbols would spell out something. This something got you the grand prize. Last year, no one won the grand prize, even though Frank got the first prize for the most answers.

This year, Larry won the Grand Prize!!! Did he invite us all over coffee? Not really!!! Oh, maybe he will volunteer to bring the coffee for our next Shindig!!! Anyway an invitation was not forthcoming.

The program was well attended, even though this time we met in the Choir/Bell Room.



Other people won prizes!! In fact, Our illustrious leader got 15 out of 25 correct.

He chose a great big stocking full of goodies!!! ➽ ➽ ➽

Well, Tony, your questions were lethal and you prizes were great!!! Dr. Eric liked your program so much that he said he's going to try it with his other clubs. Imitation is the finest form of compliment.

Once again, Larry for your philatelic acumen. We all need to practice up, because Tony is already scheduled for 2022!!! Stay tuned for ***Philatelic Quiz III !***

Yours in Philately,

Pat Richmond

STAMP COLLECTING IN THE FUTURE

BY SPENCER COSBY.

(Toronto Philatelic Journal, April 1886)

A number of articles have been making the rounds of the philatelic papers with such titles as “Stamp Collecting in 1986,” “A Stamp Collector 200 years from now,” etc. The idea is nearly the same in all of them, and usually runs about as follows: The philatelist of 1986 or 2086, or of whatever future century he may be, owns a collection numbering anywhere from fifty thousand to one hundred and fifty thousand varieties, contained in a dozen or more folio volumes, and requiring several days to be looked over. His greatest rarity is some such stamp as the two cent U.S. 1883 issue, or the three cent 1870 issue, or some other stamp common perhaps in the 19th century, but whose origin and use is now clothed in obscurity.

Articles of the above nature may be amusing, and indeed I suppose that is their object, as I do not think they give at all a correct idea of what stamp collecting will be in the future. It seems much more probable that as the number of stamps increases, collectors will become specialists and devote their attention to certain branches of philately only. This is the case in numismatics, for we only find young collectors taking coins of all nations and of all ages indiscriminately. By the time that thirty or forty thousand different stamps have been issued the number of collectors will probably be three or four times as large as it is now, and the value of obsolete stamps will have increased proportionately. The consequence will be that persons of moderate means and with no great amount of spare time will find it an utter impossibility to obtain a complete collection, and only dealers who devote their whole time to the business, and persons with plenty of money who make it their hobby will even attempt to collect stamps of all kinds. The great majority of philatelists will take up some branch suited to their means and in which they feel particular interest. Some will only collect the stamps of their own country, others will select certain countries and confine their attention to them, others again will collect only those stamps issued between certain dates.

In fact, although the number of postage stamps that have appeared up to the present day is comparatively small, many collectors have already become specialists, and a movement in that direction seems to have already begun. In Europe nearly all the advanced philatelists collect all kinds of stamps, postage, revenue, telegraph, postal cards, etc. In this country very few collectors care for revenues, and those who do keep them separate from their postage stamps. Postal cards seem also to be generally neglected, and it is only lately that persons have begun to collect envelope stamps on the whole envelope, as many consider them to have lost much of their value if cut from it. There is a large and growing class of collectors who collect only U.S. stamps and some few are beginning to discard all provisionals.

This movement towards become specialists will, in all likelihood, steadily continue, and it will not be long before it will be an exception to find a person collecting even all varieties of postage stamps.

Of course this will only be the case if new issues continue to appear as often as they do now, and from present appearances we should judge that they would. But none of us know what the future may have in store for philately, and indeed in the onward march of invention it is not at all improbable that some new and improved system of prepayment of postage may be devised which will entirely do away with the use of stamps, so that but for collectors their very existence might be forgotten a few centuries hence. – *The Stamp and Coin Gazette.*

This article is from StampoRama The Stamp Club for People Who Love Stamps, from their "Historic Articles" scetion. They have some really interesting articles in their archives.

Lea Senghaas, Ed.